Let us learn

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The Coconut Grove

Iniya was a little girl with big brown eyes. She lived with her parents in a beautiful coconut grove, next to a small blue lake. She helped her parents by the lake, went to school and then, spent time with them only to wake up the next day.

Each day, she balanced a big empty basket on her head as she walked down to the lake. Her mother followed with the laundry, and her father brought the big fishing net.



Her mother washed the clothes on a stone next to the lake, while her father went fishing. He dragged the net to the shore, and they collected the fish in a big basket.



She dreamt of a lake with no fish. In her dream, every day the father returned from the lake with no fish and the family could not support itself. The wind then said, "The water and the land have always taken care of your family, so you have to take care of them in return."

She woke up with tears in her eyes. She didn't know how to bring up Iniya without selling enough fish.

Sometimes a turtle got stuck in the net, but Iniya always hurried to save it. One sunny morning while fishing with her father, Iniya said, "Appa, if we catch so many fish, what if one day there is no fish left?" Her mother laughed and sent her off to school.

Under the shade of the trees, Iniya's mother fell into an uneasy sleep.



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